



Game cheating lawsuit

Epic Games suing 14 year-old for allegedly modding the game and causing the developer to lose profits. <http://digit.in/FNcheater>



Critical flaw in Exim

Flaw that allows remote code execution and DoS attacks found in popular mail transfer agent (MTA) software Exim. <http://digit.in/EximFlaw>

Does Pop Culture Influence Buying Habits?

Spoiler alert : Yes it does.

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Let's face it, popular media has been slowly, but surely becoming an integral part of your daily life. Memes and obscure (or not so obscure) references are now part of common parlance, fashion trends are created and killed every few months and even the things you buy are subtly influenced by pop culture. No, we aren't talking about celebrity endorsed products – who falls for that anymore? **nervously hides Being Human shirt**

No, what we'd like to tackle here is products that people tend to buy just by virtue of their appearance in popular media. It doesn't even have to be an outright plug in a movie or a show – just a product that is mentioned/seen/used by the characters. Say... the humble shawarma. Everyone who saw the 2012 blockbuster *The Avengers* (Reality check, it came out over half a decade ago people!) will definitely remember the scene near the end, where Tony Stark/Ironman selflessly almost sacrifices himself to save the world, passing out in the process and plummeting back down. The Hulk saves him from quite a nasty fall but it seems too late – until of course, Tony comes around with a sarcastic quip of "Please tell me nobody tried to kiss me" and mentions that there's this new 'Shawarma' food that's around and the Avengers team needs to try it. This leads to the iconic post credits scene of the team sitting around a table in a shawarma joint and tucking into it.

Now this scene wasn't actually in the script and ended up being an improv by Robert Downey Junior – It has quite the interesting story behind it. Read more at <http://digit.in/ShawarmaStory>. But what wasn't imagined was the huge surge in popularity that the hitherto, largely unknown-to-the-masses shawarma received.

Local shawarma joints all across the world all received a huge boost in

that was often worn by one of the main characters, Sheldon Cooper – typically relating to superheroes, mainly the Flash from DC comics. While fandom merch has been a staple in the West for a long while now, from band t-shirts to t-shirts with esoteric quotes and references on them, it was generally rare to see them in India just a few years ago. And when it caught on, several specialized stores opened up shop just



Just some colleagues enjoying a meal after you know, saving the world

interest and popularity after the release of the movie, with some joints in the US getting almost an 80% increase in sales! (<http://digit.in/MoarShawarma> and <http://digit.in/NoMoShawarma>), and this isn't confined to food either!

Again, near the start of this decade, the show *Big Bang Theory* was taking over India's geek scene. The quickest way to identify a fellow geek at a party or a gathering was to look for a t-shirt

to cater to this need. One such retailer sells up to 250 shirts *every day*, mostly catering to the 18-23 demographic. (Read more about the economics at <http://digit.in/SuperMerch>)

And it's not all material goods either. According to a study conducted by Geena Davis Institute on Gender in Media (seejane.org), female archery participation more than doubled in 2012. The institute which is